MEMORANDUM

CONFIDENTIAL ETHICAL AND STATUTORY REPORT
To: Arizona State Board of Nursing – Investigations Unit
From: Kevin D. Turnage, RN
Subject: Report of Unprofessional Conduct – Debra Louise Ward Lund, RN
Date: September 26, 2025

I. INTRODUCTION

I respectfully submit this memorandum to the Arizona State Board of Nursing under A.R.S. § 32-1664, reporting conduct by Debra Louise Ward Lund, RN, that constitutes unprofessional conduct as defined under Arizona law. Ms. Ward Lund is the current Chief Executive Officer of Phoenix Indian Medical Center (PIMC) and is a licensed Registered Nurse in the State of Arizona. Her actions in overseeing, authorizing, or facilitating retaliatory administrative proceedings against me, a fellow licensed nurse, directly violate the Nurse Practice Act and nursing ethics.

II. BACKGROUND

I serve as the Policy and Procedure Officer at Phoenix Indian Medical Center, a federally operated Indian Health Service (IHS) facility that provides care to patients from the:

- Fort McDowell Yavapai Nation
- San Lucy District of the Tohono O'odham Nation
- Tonto Apache Tribe
- Yavapai-Apache Indian Tribe
- Yavapai-Prescott Indian Tribe
- Additional tribal communities throughout Arizona, Nevada, Utah, and Mexico

In this role, I have made several good faith disclosures concerning policy violations, patient safety issues, and misuse of administrative authority. Following these disclosures, I was placed under administrative inquiry on September 25, 2025. I participated under signed assurances, and the inquiry was recorded and converted to affidavit format.

The inquiry, however, improperly focused on:

- My lawful communications up the chain of command;
- My objections to policy override practices;
- My communications to external oversight bodies;
- And my use of professional tools (e.g., Grammarly), which are not in violation of any known rule or regulation.

III. RETALIATION AND CONFLICT OF INTEREST

The inquiry was initiated following my prior protected disclosures. The questions I was asked (attached in affidavit form) reflect a clear effort to reframe whistleblower communications as "harassment," "insubordination," or "hostile conduct."

This inquiry, initiated under Ms. Ward Lund's authority, is a direct conflict of interest, as she is a named figure in my protected disclosures. Furthermore:

- I had disclosed concerns related to unsafe or unethical administrative practices.
- I followed PIMC's own policy management procedures.
- I escalated concerns only after local leadership failed to address them, including communications through the proper chain: Mr. Clinton Pope → COO Kathy Dill → CEO Debra Ward Lund → IHS Headquarters.

The retaliation I experienced, including administrative leave and removal of duties, occurred shortly after these disclosures, and after I formally notified leadership that I had filed with the U.S. Office of Special Counsel (OSC).

IV. APPLICABLE STATUTES AND ETHICAL DUTIES

A. A.R.S. § 32-1664 – Mandatory Reporting

Requires a nurse to report another nurse suspected of unprofessional conduct.

B. A.R.S. § 32-1601(16) – Unprofessional Conduct

Includes "retaliation," abuse of authority, and failure to uphold safe practice environments.

C. ANA Code of Ethics for Nurses (2025)

- Provision 3.5: Requires action when another nurse engages in unethical or retaliatory conduct.
- Provision 6: Demands creation and protection of ethical practice environments.

Ms. Ward Lund's conduct violated both state law and national ethical standards.

V. REQUEST FOR REVIEW

I respectfully request that the Board:

1. Initiate a formal investigation into Debra Louise Ward Lund, RN;
2. Determine whether her actions as a licensed nurse constitute unprofessional conduct;
3. Confirm that my actions as a reporter of misconduct were lawful, ethical, and required;
4. Take any further steps deemed appropriate under the Board's disciplinary authority.

VI. Available Documentation

If the Board wishes I can provide the following:

- Affidavit (2 parts) dated September 25, 2025, containing my full responses to the inquiry
- List of inquiry questions used during the September 25, 2025 administrative interview

I remain available to provide further information, clarification, or testimony.

Respectfully submitted,

Kevin D. Turnage, RN